

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

PATNA Digital Platform Redevelopment (Updated)

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1. Overview

Purpose

This PRD outlines the functional and non-functional requirements for redeveloping the PATNA website into a scalable digital platform that supports:

- awareness of PATNA's mission and work,
- policy influence through accessible, evidence-based content,
- structured community engagement across Africa and beyond,
- long-term coordination, learning, and institutional continuity.

The platform will combine a public website, a member community, and a unified knowledge hub, with a design that supports future AI-enabled decision support.

Background

The current PATNA website lacks flexibility for structured publishing, community engagement, multilingual expansion, governance workflows, and long-term knowledge reuse.

As PATNA's work has evolved—from maritime decarbonisation to inclusive energy transition and climate action—its digital infrastructure must also evolve. The redevelopment will therefore move beyond a traditional website and establish a living platform that reflects how PATNA actually operates.

Development will follow an iterative, phased approach, with a functional MVP delivered in the first month, followed by platform augmentation and AI-ready integration in the second month.

2. Goals & Objectives

- Support PATNA's awareness, policy influence, and coordination strategies
- Serve multilingual African and global audiences (English, French, Portuguese, Arabic)
- Enable structured onboarding and participation of PATNA members across cohorts
- Host and organise publications, insights, and event outputs in a reusable system
- Foster purposeful community engagement rather than ad-hoc interaction
- Reflect PATNA's credibility, professionalism, and leadership in global climate discourse

3. Key Features & Requirements

3.1 Functional Requirements

Feature

Description

Multilingual Support

Full platform available in EN / FR / PT / AR. Language toggle visible. Content and metadata translated.

CMS Integration

Scalable CMS to manage pages, Insights (articles, reports, briefs), and translations.

Unified Insights Hub

Single publishing system for blog articles, news, reports, briefs, event outputs, and learning notes. Content clearly labelled by type.

Knowledge Organisation

Content tagged by theme, geography, cohort relevance, and process to support discovery and reuse.

Community Onboarding

"Join the PATNA Community" flow with expression of interest, motivation statement, interview approval, and secure onboarding.

Member Profiles

Profiles capturing professional information, cohort membership, expertise, and visibility preferences.

Cohort Structure

Support for Academic, Policy, Industry, and Civil Society cohorts. Members may belong to multiple cohorts.

Community Spaces

Spaces organised by cohorts, thematic constituencies (e.g. SIDS, LDCs), and working groups.

Discussion & Moderation

Threaded discussions with moderation tools and role-based permissions.

Projects Section

Pages describing PATNA initiatives (e.g. LEAP), with outcomes and resources.

Events Calendar

Listings for past and upcoming events with summaries and outputs.

Work With Us

Structured engagement pathways for governments, funders, and collaborators, feeding into admin-managed pipelines.

Contact & Forms

Embedded multilingual forms with spam protection.

Search Functionality

Site-wide search across Insights, events, and projects.

Analytics

Integration of analytics to track engagement and content usage.

3.2 Non-Functional Requirements

Category

Requirement

Performance

Page load under 3 seconds on mobile networks; optimised assets and lazy loading.

Accessibility (WCAG 2.1)

Alt text, screen-reader compatibility, contrast compliance, keyboard navigation, RTL support for Arabic.

Security

HTTPS, secure authentication, invite-based onboarding, spam protection, role-based access control.

Scalability

Ability to add new cohorts, themes, content types, and future tools without major redesign.

User Roles

Visitor, Member, Cohort Lead, Moderator, Content Editor, Administrator.

4. Site Map (Updated, Familiar Structure)

SN

Section

Purpose / Content

1

Home

Hero, PATNA purpose, origin, featured work, partners, latest Insights, join community CTA

2

About Us

Vision, mission, story, values, governance, cohorts

3

Projects

LEAP and other initiatives with outcomes and resources

4

Insights

Unified hub for articles, reports, briefs, videos, and learning notes

5

Events

Workshops, webinars, and global events (upcoming & past)

6

Community
Cohorts, thematic spaces, member directory, engagement opportunities

7

Work With Us

Request support, partnerships, collaboration pathways

8

Contact

Contact form, details, and social links

9

Legal

Privacy, terms, compliance

(Note: The former “Blog” and “Resources” are intentionally merged into Insights.)

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5. Design Requirements

- Colour Palette: Maintain PATNA’s established visual identity
 - Typography: Clean sans-serif for clarity and accessibility
 - Imagery: Authentic African context (people, institutions, conven
- ings)
- Layout: Clean grid, generous whitespace, clear CTAs
 - Accessibility: RTL support and inclusive design standards

6. Technical Stack (Indicative, Not Prescriptive)

Component

Recommendation

CMS

WordPress or comparable CMS with role control

Multilingual

WPML / Polylang or equivalent

Hosting

Secure managed hosting

Analytics

Google Analytics 4 or Matomo

Search

CMS search with enhancement plugin

Forms

Secure form plugin with spam protection

Security

SSL, CMS hardening, firewall

(Architecture should remain extensible for future AI integration.)

7. Development Timeline (Iterative, Extended Scope)

Phase 1: Platform MVP (Weeks 1–4)

- Core website pages
- Unified Insights publishing system
- Community onboarding (expression of interest + approval)
- Member profiles and cohort assignment
- Initial community spaces
- English language launch

MVP Outcome: A usable platform supporting content publishing and structured community participation.

Phase 2: Platform Expansion & AI-Ready Integration (Weeks 5–8)

- Multilingual rollout (FR / PT / AR)
- Expanded community spaces and moderation
- Knowledge hub refinement and tagging
- Initial AI-ready indexing and retrieval logic
- QA, accessibility, and performance checks

Outcome: A robust, future-ready platform capable of supporting decision intelligence.

8. Success Metrics

- Increased time on site and repeat visits
- Engagement within community spaces
- Discoverability and reuse of Insights content
- Growth in approved community members
- Quality of inbound engagement (Work With Us)
- Stakeholder satisfaction feedback

9. Summary

This updated PRD preserves the structure and familiarity of the original document while quietly expanding its scope to support PATNA's evolution.

The platform is designed not just to publish content, but to support people, knowledge, and coordination over time, laying a durable foundation for PATNA's future work.